Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ 9 3 ♥ K Q ♦ A K Q J 9 3 ♣ Q 8 3	
♠ J 10 8 6 ♥ A 8 4 2 ♦ 5 ♣ K 9 4 2	N W E S	♠ 7 4 2 ♥ J 10 9 6 3 ♦ 8 6 4 ♣ J 6
	♠ A K Q 5 ♥ 7 5 ♦ 10 7 2 ♣ A 10 7 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6NT by North
Lead: ♥J

North is to play 6NT. East leads the ♥J. West wins the ♥A and returns the ♥2.

With only 11 winners you need to find one more and your prospects are quite slim.

No matter how the ♠s split only one defender will hold the Guard because only one defender can have as many as 4. IF (it's a big IF) that same defender holds the ♣K then you can squeeze him.

Can you see how the squeeze is going to work?

If you try to run your ♦s right away you will have a problem with your ♣Q later on. It will be no good as a Threat card because you will have no entry back to your hand.

East plays low.

The solution is the Vienna Coup: a ♣ to the ♣A at trick 3.

Then start running the ♦ suit.

This is the situation after you have unblocked dummy's ♣A and then played 5 ♦ winners.

So far neither defender is hurting, but that is about to change.

East discards.

You play your ♦3 and discard dummy's ♣10.

West is squeezed. He can't throw his ♣K without letting your ♣Q become a winner. But if he discards a ♠ dummy's ♠5 will win the last trick. This is soooo much fun.

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ 9 3 ♥ K 9 8 6 3 ♦ A 6 ♣ A K Q 5	
♠ Q J 10 6 4 ♥ 10 ♦ 10 9 7 4 2 ♣ 8 2		♠ A 8 5 2 ♥ 4 ♦ K Q 8 3 ♣ J 10 9 3
	♠ K 7 ♥ A Q J 7 5 2 ♦ J 5 ♣ 7 6 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♥
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by South
Lead: ♠Q

Play 5 ♥ winners and the ♠K.

Drum roll please.

West discards.

Play your ♥2 and dump dummy's ♦6.

East has no answer.

South is to play 6♥. West leads the ♠Q. East wins the ♠A and plays the ♦K.

Of course you have noticed that in most of these hands you are exactly one trick short. No coincidence - it's when you are one trick short and can't find another likely plan that you start to look for a squeeze.

In this hand dummy's fourth ♣ is an obvious Threat, so you should ask yourself if you can find another Threat for when ♣s don't split 3-3. Another thing you have probably noticed is that although 3-3 splits happen about 40% of the time in real life, they **NEVER** happen in these pages!

East's ♦K play helps you find the other Threat. It appears that he must hold the ♦Q also, so your ♦J is now a Threat against East. If he holds 4 ♣s you can squeeze him.

Board 3
West Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ K Q 7 3 ♥ A 4 ♦ Q 9 6 2 ♣ A 8 4	
♠ J 10 9 6 4 ♥ 9 8 3 2 ♦ — ♣ Q 10 6 3	N W E S	♠ 8 ♥ K Q 10 7 5 ♦ 10 8 4 ♣ J 9 5 2
	♠ A 5 2 ♥ J 6 ♦ A K J 7 5 3 ♣ K 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
Pass	1NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

7NT by North
Lead: ♥K

North is to play 7NT. East leads the ♥K, dummy plays the ♥6 and West the ♥2.

With 12 obvious tricks your first thought should be that perhaps the ♠s will split 3-3.

Then, your second thought should be that dummy's ♥J is a Threat against East's ♥Q, so if it is East who holds 4 ♠s you will be able to squeeze him.

Since the contract is 7NT you take the first trick with the ♥A.

With one trick in the bag you should test ♦s next. When you play the ♦A West discards a ♠.

You continue with the ♦Q and ♦ K, West discarding a ♥ and a ♣.

Since West has shown up with a ♦ void he has become the odds-on favorite to hold the ♠ Guard. His ♠ discard makes it very likely that he started with 5 ♠s.

To find out for sure you play ♠A, then ♠Q. Sure enough East discards a ♥ on the second round.

You can't squeeze East in ♥s and ♠s because he doesn't hold the ♠ Guard, West does.

But now a completely new possibility shows up. Say to yourself, over and over, "East must guard ♥s, and West must guard ♠s. Nobody can guard ♣s."

You start playing dummy's ♦ winners.

With one more ♦ in dummy, things look like this.

West discards the ♣6.

When you play the ♦5 West must keep both ♠s to guard against your ♠7. So he discards the ♣6, hoping partner can stop that suit.

Your ♠7 is now worthless so you throw it.

East has no problem, (yet), he discards the ♥10.

It is now time to pressure East.

Play dummy's ♠5 to your ♠K.

East MUST keep his ♥Q so he releases his ♣5.

And you win the last three tricks with ♣K, ♣A, ♣8.

This is called a Double Squeeze.

Board 4
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ 9 5 2 ♥ 6 ♦ A J 9 7 4 ♣ Q 8 4 3	
♠ Q J 10 8 3 ♥ J 10 7 2 ♦ 6 3 ♣ 10 6	N W E S	♠ 6 ♥ Q 9 8 4 3 ♦ 8 5 2 ♣ J 9 7 5
	♠ A K 7 4 ♥ A K 5 ♦ K Q 10 ♣ A K 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	3♦	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

7NT by South
Lead: ♠Q

South is to play 7NT. West leads the ♠Q.

One more winner is needed. Dummy's fourth ♣ is a possibility.

So take the ♠K and play ♣ A K Q.

West discards a ♠ on the third ♣.

Now you know East guards the ♣s.

Before tackling ♦s, see what you can discover about ♠s.

Play the ♠A. East discards a ♥.

East guards the ♣s. West guards the ♠s. Nobody can guard the ♥s.

Play 4 rounds of ♦s.

On the fourth ♦ East had to discard a ♥. You discarded a small ♠. West discarded a ♠ on the third ♦ and a ♥ on the fourth.

East discards a ♥.

You play dummy's ♦4. East cannot throw the ♣J or he will set up dummy's ♣8, so he discards a ♥.

You discard the ♠7.

Now West is squeezed. He cannot discard the ♠J or he will set up dummy's ♠9, so he discards a ♥.

You win the last three ♥ tricks with another Double Squeeze.

Board 5
North Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 5 ♥ A K J 9 8 3 ♦ A 5 ♣ K 8 6 3	
♠ Q 6 2 ♥ 7 5 2 ♦ J 9 8 4 3 ♣ J 4	N W E S	♠ A K J 9 4 ♥ 6 4 ♦ 10 7 2 ♣ Q 10 2
	♠ 10 8 7 3 ♥ Q 10 ♦ K Q 6 ♣ A 9 7 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	1♠	2♣
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♥ by North
Lead: ♠A

from your hand.

Then lead dummy's ♣7 to your ♣K.

Here you are in your hand.

Only East can guard dummy's ♠10, and only East can guard dummy's♣9.

East discards the ♣10, holding on to the ♠J.

You play your ♥A and East must give up one of his guards. If he holds on to the ♠J then you toss dummy's useless ♠10. If he throws the ♠J then you toss dummy's ♣9.

North is to play 6♥. East leads the ♠A, then ♠K.

When you looked at just your and dummy's cards on the previous page it may have looked impossible to find a twelfth winner.

Even looking at all four hands here it is still very difficult to come up with a plan.

Here's a hint: If East holds 3 ♣s, (and you see that he does), can you squeeze him in ♣s and ♠s?

Of course you ruffed the ♠K.

The big problem with trying to squeeze East in the black suits right now is that West actually holds a ♠ guard. But you can fix that.

You draw two rounds of trumps with dummy's ♥Q and ♥10.

West plays the ♠Q and you ruff. Then you pull the last trump.

Now play the ♦A, ♦K, and ♦Q, discarding the ♣3